

TOOL

Prioritize Objectives

Review the example scenario and series of potential objectives. Imagine you are the product manager and it is your job to determine priorities.

Instructions:

1. Choose your top 3 objectives from the list and deprioritize the others.
2. Note your choices and their justifications in the spaces below.

Scenario:

You work for a startup that has built a smartwatch. Your team has been working on it for 18 months and has shipped version 1.0. It shows promise but lags behind competitive products because you haven't had time to build out all of the functionality. You have a small team, so you can only tackle so many projects at the same time. Below is a list of potential objectives for you to prioritize for the next 3 months (1 quarter). Please select your top 3 objectives and justify why those objectives are so critical. Also, take notes on the deprioritized objectives to justify why those are not as important as your top 3.

Potential objectives:

1. Improve the battery life.

Context: Today you get 1 day of battery life and competitive products get 4-7. Users get frustrated when the watch dies, and you believe with some power optimization algorithms you can improve battery life from 1 day to 3-4.

2. Make the experience more social to create virality.

Context: You have a phone app that works alongside your watch, as do your competitors. However, your app only shows the user's own information, including heart rate, steps, and sleep quality. Competitive products have social aspects in their app so users can share results with friends, encourage each other, and have competitions. Your team believes that building out these components will help grow your user base and keep customers from defecting.



3. Improve the accuracy of the heart-rate monitor.

Context: Your heart-rate monitor works but is not accurate enough for serious athletes. You have two key projects that you believe will improve the accuracy enough to be able to compete in this aspect.

4. Reduce the cost by 20%.

Context: There are a number of components you could swap out to reduce the cost of each device by 20%. Right now your price point is too high to be competitive with your current set of functionality. You believe that it's urgent to either reduce cost or quickly improve functionality to compete with high-end devices, or both.

5. Build the ability to capture swimming and biking activities.

Context: There are a number of triathletes who use smartwatches. Right now your watch is effective for running, but not swimming or biking. You believe that over the next quarter, if your team focused on it, you could make the device usable for swimming and biking. It wouldn't be top of the line in those categories, but it would be usable. With further investment down the road, you believe you could make it top of the line.

6. Improve the experience by displaying phone notifications and text messages on the screen.

Context: Right now your watch does not have the capability to show phone notifications, and this is highly requested by users and available on all alternative watches, both low end and high end. You believe in one quarter you can build an effective set of features that would be on par with all competitive watches.

7. Develop new wrist bands to improve the customizability and fashionability of the watch.

Context: Your product is newer than competitors, so your design isn't where you want it to be yet. Bringing some new wristbands to market would give people a better opportunity to customize the watch and feel like it's part of their identity and style.



Prioritize objectives:

List objectives in ranking order, and describe your justification for prioritizing or deprioritizing each objective.

Objective #1:

Justification for prioritizing or deprioritizing:

Objective #2:

Justification for prioritizing or deprioritizing:

Objective #3:

Justification for prioritizing or deprioritizing:



Objective #4:

Justification for prioritizing or deprioritizing:

Objective #5:

Justification for prioritizing or deprioritizing:

Objective #6:

Justification for prioritizing or deprioritizing:

Objective #7:

Justification for prioritizing or deprioritizing:

